
EagleEye

Cloud (Remote) Firmware

Technical Reference & Setup Guide

*The remote / product firmware for the ESP32-CAM surveillance node: camera at a site, phone anywhere. The device connects **outbound** to the cloud and stays connected, so its IP never matters.*

Module	firmware/eagleeye-cloud/
Target	ESP32-CAM (AI Thinker, PSRAM)
Firmware	v1.0.0-cloud
Plan	distributed-roaming-candy.md
Status	Phases P1-P4 implemented (device side)

Independent of firmware/eagleeye-main/ (the LAN build is untouched).

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1 Overview

This document describes the **cloud / remote** build of the EagleEye ESP32-CAM firmware. Unlike the LAN build in `firmware/eagleeye-main/` (where the phone reaches *into* the camera by its local IP), this build inverts the topology: the device dials **out** to cloud services and holds the connection open — exactly how a phone receives push messages anywhere without a fixed IP. This removes the manual-IP problem, the port-forwarding/NAT problem, and the dependency on a PC at the site.

It implements the approved plan `distributed-roaming-candy.md`:

- **Plane 1 — Control & alerts** over a managed cloud MQTT broker (TLS).
- **Plane 2 — Live video** via an on-demand cloud WebSocket relay.
- **Direct HTTPS upload** of intruder images to Cloundinary (no PC bridge).
- **Phase 4 — Wi-Fi provisioning portal, HTTPS OTA, and TLS hardening.**

2 Architecture

SITE A		CLOUD		ANYWHERE
+-----+	outbound TLS	+-----+	wss (mqtt.js)	+-----+
ESP32-CAM	---- 8883 ----->	HiveMQ MQTT	<-----	App
+ helper	status/alert	broker(TLS)	cmd: arm/servo/	
	sub cmd	+-----+	stream on/off	+-----+
image ---+--HTTPS-->	Cloudinary -->	ingestAlert(CF) -->	RTDB -->	app list
video ---+--wss---->	relay (Node ws) -->	app	(ON-DEMAND, token-gated)	
+-----+				

Two planes with different needs: **control + alerts** are small, reliable, and always-connected (MQTT/TLS + HTTPS + RTDB); **video** is bursty and high-bandwidth (on-demand relay, hardware-JPEG frames).

3 File Map

File	Role
<code>eagleeye-cloud.ino</code>	Main sketch: AI loop, DeviceMode dispatch, command handling, setup.
<code>config.h</code>	All settings (fill the DEV_* defaults) + NVS load/save + topic helpers + feature flags.
<code>eagleeye_camera.h</code>	Camera pins; MODE_AI (RGB565) vs MODE_RELAY (hardware JPEG); safe mode switch; <code>eagleeye_grab_jpeg</code> .
<code>EagleEye_Cloud_IoT.h</code>	MQTT-over-TLS: retained status + LWT, cmd parsing, alert publish, SNTP, non-blocking reconnect, <code>capture_and_send_image</code> .
<code>eagleeye_upload.h</code>	Direct HTTPS upload to Cloundinary (unsigned preset) + <code>ingest_alert</code> to a Cloud Function.
<code>eagleeye_relay.h</code>	Outbound wss relay client (Plane 2); on-demand with idle / max-session caps.
<code>eagleeye_ota.h</code>	MQTT-triggered HTTPS OTA (Phase 4).
<code>eagleeye_provision.h</code>	Wi-Fi captive-portal setup (Phase 4, off by default).

4 Required Arduino Libraries

- **PubSubClient** (knolleary) — MQTT.
- **ArduinoJson** (v6) — JSON encode/decode.
- **WebSockets** (Markus Sattler / Links2004) — relay client.
- **final_inferencing** — the EI v7.16 RGB 96 × 96 library (same one `eagleeye-main` uses).
- **WiFiManager** (tzapu) — *only if* `ENABLE_PROVISIONING` is set to 1.

Board: **AI Thinker ESP32-CAM**, PSRAM enabled. For OTA, choose an **OTA-capable Partition Scheme** (Arduino IDE → Tools → Partition Scheme).

5 Configuration (`config.h`)

Edit the `DEV_*` defaults before flashing: Wi-Fi credentials, HiveMQ host / user / password, Cloudinary cloud name and **unsigned upload preset**, and (later) the Cloud Function URLs and relay host. These are compile-time defaults; the Phase-4 portal can override them at runtime into NVS, so no re-flashing is needed to change networks in the field.

6 Cloud Setup (Your Accounts)

1. **HiveMQ Cloud** (free tier): create a cluster and two credentials with topic permissions — a *device* credential (publish `status/alert/stream`, subscribe `cmd`) and an *app* credential (publish `cmd`, subscribe the rest), each scoped to `eagleeye/<id>/#`.
2. **Cloudinary**: create an **unsigned upload preset** that forces `folder=eagleeye_intrusions`, `resource_type=image`, and a max size. The API secret is *never* placed on the device.
3. **Firestore Cloud Functions** (Phases 2–3): `ingestAlert` (writes RTDB alerts/ so the app's existing list shows it), `onDeleteRequest` (Cloudinary destroy — replaces `bridge.py`), `issueStreamToken` (short-lived relay tokens).
4. **Relay** (Phase 3): a small Node `ws` server on Fly.io / Railway exposing `wss://`.

7 Topics & Command Format

<code>eagleeye/<id>/status</code>	retained + LWT	<code>{"online":true,"armed":true,"fw":"...","rssi":-62}</code>
<code>eagleeye/<id>/cmd</code>	subscribe	<code>{"type":"arm","value":true}</code> <code>{"type":"servo","angle":90}</code> <code>{"type":"stream","value":true}</code> <code>{"type":"ota","url":"https://.../fw.bin"}</code> <code>{"type":"factory_reset"}</code>
<code>eagleeye/<id>/alert</code>	publish	<code>{"ts":...,"image_url":...,"public_id":...,"score":...,"type":"Human Detected"}</code>
<code>eagleeye/<id>/stream</code> the relay)	publish	<code>{"ready":true}</code> (tells the app to attach to

8 TLS Memory (Design Rationale)

The ESP32-S1 cannot hold three TLS sessions at once. A single state machine `DeviceMode { MODE_AI, MODE_UPLOADING, MODE_RELAY }` (in `eagleeye_camera.h`) guarantees that **at most one of {HTTPS upload, WSS relay} is open at a time**. The persistent **MQTTs** session stays small because the old ~50 KB image buffer is gone (`setBufferSize(1024)`); JPEGs now travel over HTTPS instead of MQTT. HTTPS upload clients are scope-local and freed immediately after each upload, so the heap is reclaimed at once.

9 Phase Status (This Firmware)

Phase	State	Notes
P1 control / status	Done	MQTTs, LWT, retained status, <code>cmd→servo/arm/stream</code> .
P2 upload + alert	Done	Clouinary unsigned upload; <code>ingest_alert</code> no-ops until <code>DEV_INGEST_URL</code> is set.
P3 relay video	Done	Hardware-JPEG switch + <code>wss</code> client; needs relay host + <code>issueStreamToken</code> .
P4 prov / OTA / sec	Done*	OTA on by default; provisioning behind <code>ENABLE_PROVISIONING</code> ; TLS uses <code>setInsecure()</code> for dev — set <code>TLS_INSECURE 0</code> and pin CA certs for production.

10 Bring-up Order (Recommended)

1. Fill Wi-Fi + HiveMQ credentials, flash, and watch serial for: Wi-Fi join, SNTP, [MQTT] ok, and a retained `status` message in the HiveMQ web client. Cut power → `online:false` appears via the LWT.
2. From the HiveMQ web client, publish to `eagleeye/cam-01/cmd`: `{"type":"servo","angle":120}` (servo moves) and `{"type":"arm","value":false}`.
3. Add the Clouinary preset, trigger a detection → the image appears in `eagleeye_intrusions`. Deploy `ingestAlert` so it lands in RTDB and the app shows it; then retire Mosquitto + `bridge.py`.
4. Deploy the relay + `issueStreamToken`, set `DEV_RELAY_HOST` / `DEV_TOKEN_URL`, then `{"type":"stream","value":true}` → frames flow; `false` stops.
5. Production: rotate the leaked Clouinary / Firebase credentials, set `TLS_INSECURE 0` and pin CAs, and enable provisioning.

11 Security Note

The Clouinary API secret in `backend/bridge.py` / `.env` and the committed Firebase `serviceAccountKey.json` are **burned** — rotate them and purge them from git history before shipping. This firmware deliberately holds **no** Clouinary secret (it uses an unsigned preset) and only its own scoped MQTT credentials.

EagleEye FYP — generated technical reference for the cloud firmware module. See `distributed-roaming-candy.md` for the full multi-phase plan including the mobile-app and cloud-service deliverables.